EXTRAORDINARY MINDS
WITH VISHEN LAKHIANI

× Alba Health

STARTS MONDAY
16 NOVEMBER 2026

YOUR FREE 30-DAY GUIDE

30-30-30 Fibre Challenge

Thirty days to feed your gut properly. A simple, add-don't-remove plan from Vishen Lakhiani and microbiome scientist Nora Cavani, with recipes, trackers and one small thing to do every day.



13 plants on one table
Lettuce, beetroot, radicchio, pak choi, onions, garlic, courgettes, tomato, kohlrabi and more. Most of a week's variety, in one market trip.

30
DAYS

Monday 16 November to Tuesday 15 December. Measure on day one, measure again on day thirty-one.

30g
FIBRE A DAY

The daily amount health guidelines recommend. Most adults eat about half of it.

30
PLANTS A WEEK

Thirty different plants, counted across seven days. Fruit, veg, grains, beans, nuts, seeds, herbs and spices all count.

Seven weeks. Seven centimetres. *One missing nutrient.*

A note from Vishen

I measure my waist every week. Last year, travelling through Malaysia, Korea and the US, it grew 7 cm in seven weeks. I was shopping at Whole Foods, eating plenty of protein, doing cyclical keto. I was down to three pairs of trousers that fitted.

Back home in Europe I started photographing every meal and asking AI to analyse it. On day five it told me something I had never thought about: I was very low on fibre.

So I made one change. A bowl of Greek yoghurt every morning with berries, chia, psyllium, seeds and cinnamon. My waist started coming down by about a centimetre a week. It went from 87 cm back to around 80, and my body fat on an InBody scan went from 18.1% to 14.4%. I changed other things too, but fibre was the biggest.

Then I heard Nora explain the 30-30 rule on stage. I was getting about 15 grams a day, from a handful of foods. Half the dose and almost none of the variety. This guide is what we built so you can do the whole thing in thirty days.

Vishen

A note from Nora

At 27 I developed eczema from my neck to my feet. I tried every cream I could find, with and without cortisone, and the rash never went away. Allergies, digestive problems and low mood followed. I had trained in molecular biology and spent years in eczema research, so I went looking for the source of the inflammation. Again and again, the trail led to the gut, and to fibre.

Your own cells can't digest fibre. The bacteria in your gut can, and what they make from it is linked to your digestion, immune system, skin, mood and more. I picture the gut as a forest. Lots of different plants make it rich. Feed it the same few foods and it starts to look like a desert, with space for the wrong microbes to move in.

You don't need to cut anything for this. Keep the meals you love and add to them. Start with breakfast, go slowly, and let your gut adjust.

Nora

Who's who

Vishen Lakhiani hosts the Extraordinary Minds podcast. **Nora Cavani** is a molecular biologist and the founder and CEO of Alba Health, which tests the gut microbiome of children and adults. She was named Web Summit's European female founder of the year in 2025.

> "Fibre is the most underrated biohack ever."
>
> NORA CAVANI, ON EXTRAORDINARY MINDS

Two numbers. *One gut.*

Thirty grams feeds your gut bacteria enough. Thirty different plants feeds enough different kinds of them. You need both.

96%
of UK adults eat less than the recommended 30 g of fibre a day. Only 4% hit it.

7%
of UK adults know the 30 g recommendation exists.

10-15
plant types a week: Nora's estimate of what most people eat.

30+
plants a week went with a richer mix of fibre-loving gut bacteria in the American Gut study.

What fibre is

Fibre is the part of a plant your body can't break down. It passes through your stomach and small intestine and reaches your large intestine intact. There, trillions of bacteria ferment it.

As they ferment it they make short-chain fatty acids such as butyrate. Butyrate fuels the cells that line your gut and helps keep that lining strong. Fibre also bulks up stool, helps food move through, and slows the rise in blood sugar after a meal.

Why variety counts

Different bacteria eat different fibres. Oats, lentils, onions, berries and walnuts each carry their own kinds. Eat the same five foods every day and you feed the same few species. Eat thirty and you feed a crowd.

That is where the 30 plants comes from. In the American Gut Project, people who ate more than 30 plant types a week had more of the bacteria that turn fibre into short-chain fatty acids than people who ate fewer than 10. It's a practical goal, not a magic line.

Nora's forest

Picture your gut as a forest. Many species, living in balance, each producing compounds the rest of your body uses.

When variety drops, the forest thins towards a desert. Two things happen. You lose the species that make the good compounds. And empty ground opens up for less friendly microbes, which can drive low-level inflammation.

Research published in *Nature* in 2026 suggests modern Western guts may have lost up to half their diversity compared with our ancestors. Studies of the Hadza, hunter-gatherers in Tanzania who eat hundreds of wild plant foods a year, find far more varied gut microbes than in people living in Western cities.



Avocado, pomegranate, apple, mint, orange, blueberries, pumpkin seeds, chia, kale and quinoa. Ten plants in one bowl.

What counts as *a plant?*

More than you think. Every different plant you eat in a week counts once, however small the amount. Spot the six groups and thirty gets easy.

1. Vegetables

Broccoli, carrots, spinach, kale, peppers, courgette, onion, garlic, leeks, cabbage, beetroot, mushrooms, sweet potato, tomatoes, rocket, cauliflower, asparagus, celery, cucumber, radish.

2. Fruit

Raspberries, blueberries, blackberries, kiwi, banana, apple, pear, orange, pomegranate, mango, avocado, grapes, cherries, figs, dates, lemon, lime, persimmon, plums.

3. Whole grains

Oats, brown rice, wild rice, quinoa, buckwheat, barley, spelt, rye, bulgur wheat, freekeh, millet, popcorn, wholewheat pasta and bread.

4. Legumes

Lentils (red, green, brown, puy), chickpeas, black beans, kidney beans, butter beans, cannellini, borlotti, edamame, peas, baked beans, hummus.

5. Nuts and seeds

Chia, ground flaxseed, psyllium, pumpkin seeds, sunflower seeds, sesame, hemp, almonds, walnuts, hazelnuts, pistachios, cashews, Brazil nuts, peanut butter.

6. Herbs and spices

Cinnamon, turmeric, cumin, paprika, ginger, black pepper, oregano, rosemary, thyme, basil, parsley, coriander, mint, dill, chilli, nutmeg.

The counting rules

- [ ] **Count each plant once a week.** Blueberries on Monday and Thursday are one plant.
- [ ] **Colours of the same plant are one plant.** Red, yellow and green peppers count once, though the colours bring different plant compounds, so mix them anyway.
- [ ] **Herbs and spices count.** You eat them in small amounts, so lean on them often.
- [ ] **A few extras count too:** coffee, tea, extra virgin olive oil and dark chocolate of 70% cocoa or more.
- [ ] **Juice doesn't count.** Juicing throws away the fibre. Blend into a smoothie and keep the pulp.



Yoghurt with blueberries, pomegranate, walnuts, black sesame and golden kiwi. Five plants before 9am.

QUICK TEST

Did it grow from the ground or on a plant, and is it close to how it grew? Count it. Highly processed foods made from plants, like crisps or white bread, don't earn a place.

Thirty days, *one small step a day.*

You don't need a new diet. You need this guide, a tracker and the meals you already eat.

1 Measure on day one

Men, measure your waist. Women, measure your hips. Fill in the baseline page, then put the tape away until day 31.

2 Do one thing a day

Each day on the calendar has one small action. Tick it off. Most take under ten minutes.

3 Track grams and plants

Log your fibre and every new plant in the week pages, a spreadsheet or the Vibrantly app. If you don't track it, you won't know if you hit 30.

4 Join the live calls

Nora goes live three times during the challenge, roughly every ten days, to teach and answer your questions. Dates and links arrive by email.

5 Share what you learn

Post your bowls, swaps and wins in the free challenge community. On day 31, measure again and tell us what changed.

Start slow, and go at your own pace

If you don't usually eat much fibre, take it step by step. A big jump can bring bloating, wind or tummy ache while your gut bacteria adjust.

- **Build up gradually.** Follow the weekly targets below. If fibre is new to you, start at the lower end.
- **Drink more water as you go.** Fibre pulls water into the gut, so have a glass with every meal.
- **If you feel unwell, ease off.** Go back to the previous week's target, or hold where you are for a few days. Move up again once you feel fine.
- **There's no rush.** Reaching 30 g in six weeks instead of four is still a win.



Daily fibre targets. Plant targets build the same way: aim for 15 different plants in week one, 20 in week two, 25 in week three and 30 in week four.

THE WATER RULE

Aim for 1.5 to 2 litres of water a day, plus an extra glass for every 10 g of fibre you add. Fibre without enough fluid can leave you more constipated, not less.

A day on the challenge

Morning
The breakfast bowl or chia pudding. 15 to 18 g and up to 8 plants before you leave the house.

Lunch
Whatever you normally eat, plus beans, lentils or a handful of seeds.

Afternoon
A piece of fruit, a few nuts or veg sticks with hummus.

Evening
Your usual dinner with one extra veg. Log the day: grams, new plants, how your gut feels.

Where you are *today.*

Fill this in on Monday 16 November, before you change anything. You'll compare it on day 31.

DATE

WAIST (MEN) OR HIPS (WOMEN), CM

OPTIONAL: WEIGHT, OR HOW ONE PAIR OF TROUSERS FITS

MY FIBRE YESTERDAY, ROUGHLY (G)

DIFFERENT PLANTS I ATE IN THE LAST 7 DAYS

WHY I'M DOING THIS

How I feel, 1 to 10

Circle one number per line. Gut changes often show up first in these, before the tape measure moves.

Energy	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Digestion and regularity	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Bloating (10 = none)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Sleep	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Mood	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Skin	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Cravings (10 = none)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

FOODS I ALREADY EAT THAT COUNT AS PLANTS

DO THIS TODAY

- [ ] Take a photo of your fridge and cupboard. Count the plants in them.
- [ ] Make Nora's breakfast bowl (page 8), at half size if fibre is new to you.
- [ ] Download a tracker or open the week 1 page.
- [ ] Fill in your baseline numbers above.

Where the grams *come from.*

Approximate fibre per portion. Brands and ripeness vary, so check the label when you can. Beans, lentils, seeds and berries do most of the heavy lifting.

Fruit

FOOD	PORTION	FIBRE G
Raspberries	80 g handful	5
Pear, with skin	1 medium	5
Avocado	½ fruit	4.5
Apple, with skin	1 medium	3.5
Orange	1 medium	3
Kiwi	1 fruit	2
Blueberries	80 g handful	2
Banana	½ fruit	1.5

Vegetables

FOOD	PORTION	FIBRE G
Sweet potato, with skin	1 medium	4.5
Peas	80 g	4
Brussels sprouts	80 g	3
Broccoli	80 g	2.5
Carrot	1 medium	2
Kale, cooked	80 g	2

Beans and lentils

FOOD	PORTION	FIBRE G
Black beans	120 g cooked	8
Lentils	120 g cooked	7
Baked beans	½ tin	7
Chickpeas	120 g cooked	6
Edamame	80 g	4

Whole grains

FOOD	PORTION	FIBRE G
Wholewheat pasta	75 g dry	6
Porridge oats	40 g dry	4
Quinoa	50 g dry	3.5
Rye crispbread	2 slices	3
Popcorn	20 g	3
Wholemeal bread	1 slice	2.5
Brown rice	75 g dry	2.5

Nuts, seeds and extras

FOOD	PORTION	FIBRE G
Chia seeds	1 tbsp	4
Psyllium husk	1 tsp	4
Almonds	30 g	3.5
Ground flaxseed	1 tbsp	2.5
Dark chocolate, 85%	20 g	2
Walnuts	30 g	2
Peanut butter	1 tbsp	1
Cinnamon	1 tsp	1

What a 30 g day looks like

Breakfast bowl (page 8)	15-18
Lunch: big salad with half a tin of chickpeas and seeds	8
Snack: an apple	3.5
Dinner: your usual meal plus a side of broccoli	4-6

Half your day's fibre *before 9am.*

Nora's advice is to start with breakfast, because it's the easiest meal to change. Vishen made this bowl on the podcast and ate it in five minutes.

The fibre breakfast bowl

One bowl. About 18 g of fibre and 8 plants. Two minutes, no cooking.

200 g Greek yoghurt or kefir, high protein	0
Handful of raspberries (80 g)	5
Small handful of blueberries	1
1 kiwi, sliced	2
½ banana, slightly green	1.5
1 tbsp chia seeds	4
1 tsp psyllium husk	4
1 tbsp pumpkin seeds	0.5
Pinch of cinnamon	0.5
Total, roughly	**18 g**

Why yoghurt? Yoghurt has no fibre. It carries the fibre, adds protein and brings live bacteria. Kefir can carry around three times as many live cultures, so alternate. Skip the honey: cinnamon gives you sweetness without the sugar. A spoon of peanut butter is fine. **New to fibre?** Leave out the psyllium in week one.



Yoghurt with raspberries, blackberries, blueberries, red grapes, redcurrants and mint.

Overnight chia pudding

Stir 3 tbsp chia seeds into 200 ml milk or kefir. Leave in the fridge overnight. Top with kiwi, blueberries and a spoon of coconut flakes.

About 15 g fibre, 4 to 5 plants. Make three jars on Sunday night for the week.

Vishen's green smoothie

Blend two handfuls of mixed veg (spinach, kale, cucumber, celery, courgette, rocket) with half a green apple, a few mint leaves, a squeeze of lime and 1 tbsp ground flaxseed.

About 6 g fibre, 6 or more plants. Blend, don't juice. The pulp is where the fibre is.



Oat and chia porridge with stewed apple, yoghurt and cinnamon.



Chia pudding with banana, walnut, blueberry and kiwi.



Dragon fruit, kiwi and berries, with a spinach omelette.

Keep the meal. *Add one thing.*

Alba's rule for every meal: keep what you already love, then add or swap one thing. A fruit or vegetable, a whole grain, beans or lentils, nuts or seeds, or a herb or spice.

Upgrade the meals you already make

YOU MAKE	ADD THIS
An omelette	Spinach, chopped peppers and a spoon of seeds
Pancakes	Half chickpea or buckwheat flour, a teaspoon of psyllium, berries on top
Spaghetti bolognese	A tin of lentils into the sauce, grated carrot and courgette
A curry	A tin of chickpeas and a bag of spinach at the end
Soup	A tin of butter beans, blended in or left whole
Tacos or a wrap	Black beans, red cabbage, avocado, coriander
Salmon or chicken	A tray of roast veg with rosemary and cumin
Toast	Wholegrain or rye bread, smashed avocado, sesame
Crackers and cheese	Rye crispbread, apple slices, walnuts

One bolognese, two ways

Usual	Beef, onion, tinned tomatoes, white spaghetti. **3 plants, about 4 g fibre a serving.**
Upgraded	Same beef, plus a tin of lentils, grated carrot and courgette, garlic, oregano and wholewheat spaghetti. **8 plants, about 12 g fibre a serving.**

Same dinner, same family, nothing taken away.

Three easy swaps

White rice	Brown rice, quinoa or half and half
White pasta	Wholewheat, lentil or chickpea pasta
White bread	Wholegrain, rye or seeded sourdough

Nora's view is that white bread is one swap worth making always. It has almost no fibre and can raise blood sugar quickly.

Build a fibre bar

Vishen keeps a row of glass jars at home and at his desk, with yoghurt in the office fridge. Fill yours with:

Chia · ground flaxseed · psyllium · pumpkin seeds · sunflower seeds · sesame · hemp · walnuts · almonds · cinnamon

Or mix a jar of seeds and nuts and sprinkle it on anything. That's up to eight plants a week from one jar.



One tray: chickpeas, tomato, spinach, green beans, broccoli, mushrooms, savoy cabbage, onion.

Your 30 days, *one action each.*

Pin this page to the fridge. Do the day's action and tick the box. Missed one? Pick up the next day and keep going.

1 ☐ MON 16 NOV Measure your waist or hips. Make the breakfast bowl.	**2** ☐ TUE 17 Count the plants in your kitchen. Write a list of 10 to buy.	**3** ☐ WED 18 Add berries and chia to breakfast.	**4** ☐ THU 19 Swap white bread for wholegrain or rye.	**5** ☐ FRI 20 Fill a jar with mixed seeds and nuts.
6 ☐ SAT 21 Add a tin of beans to one meal.	**7** ☐ SUN 22 Count your week's plants. Aim for 15.	**8** ☐ MON 23 Add one plant to every meal today.	**9** ☐ TUE 24 Stir lentils into a sauce or soup.	**10** ☐ WED 25 Make the green smoothie. Keep the pulp.
11 ☐ THU 26 Use three fresh herbs in one day.	**12** ☐ FRI 27 Swap to wholewheat pasta or brown rice.	**13** ☐ SAT 28 Snack on fruit and nuts in place of crackers.	**14** ☐ SUN 29 Count your plants. Aim for 20.	**15** ☐ MON 30 Cook with three spices you rarely use.
16 ☐ TUE 1 DEC Buy a plant you've never bought before.	**17** ☐ WED 2 Eat five colours of plant today.	**18** ☐ THU 3 Make a salad with three kinds of bean.	**19** ☐ FRI 4 Try a new grain: buckwheat, barley or bulgur.	**20** ☐ SAT 5 Eat whole fruit in place of juice.
21 ☐ SUN 6 Count your plants. Aim for 25.	**22** ☐ MON 7 Pair a ferment with fibre: kefir and berries.	**23** ☐ TUE 8 Batch-cook one big tray of beans and veg.	**24** ☐ WED 9 Cook a fibre meal with someone at home.	**25** ☐ THU 10 Set up a fibre bar at your desk.
26 ☐ FRI 11 Eating out? Order the extra veg side.	**27** ☐ SAT 12 Hit 30 g without the breakfast bowl.	**28** ☐ SUN 13 Count your plants. Aim for 30.	**29** ☐ MON 14 Write your ten go-to plants for after the challenge.	**30** ☐ TUE 15 A full 30-30 day. Share your best recipe.

Week 1 start with breakfast **Week 2** add, don't remove **Week 3** grow the variety **Week 4** make it stick. Day 31, Wednesday 16 December: measure again. Nora's three live calls fall roughly every ten days.

01

Start with *breakfast.*

This week has one job: make breakfast do the work. One fibre-rich bowl gets you halfway to 30 grams before the day starts. Everything else stays the same.

TARGET: 15-20 G A DAY GOAL: 15 PLANTS THIS WEEK

New to fibre? Start at 15 g. Drink a glass of water with every meal.



Chia pudding with kiwi, blueberries and coconut.

THIS WEEK, DO THIS

- [ ] Make the breakfast bowl or chia pudding at least five mornings.
- [ ] Leave out the psyllium if you feel bloated. Add it back in week 2.
- [ ] Drink 1.5 to 2 litres of water a day, plus an extra glass for every 10 g of fibre you add.
- [ ] Write down every new plant as you eat it. Herbs and spices count.

IF YOU FEEL UNWELL

Halve the bowl and hold there for a few days, then build back up once you feel fine. Some wind is normal early on. If it's painful or doesn't settle, talk to your doctor.

Plants this week

Write each new plant in a box the first time you eat it this week.

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

Daily log

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Fibre (g)							
Water (glasses)							
New plants							
Gut feel (1-5)							

WHAT WORKED, AND WHAT I'LL KEEP

02

Add, *don't remove.*

Now take the habit to lunch and dinner. Keep every meal you love and add one or two sources of fibre to it. Beans and lentils are the fastest route: pre-cooked, cheap and packed with fibre.

TARGET: 20-25 G A DAY

GOAL: 20 PLANTS THIS WEEK

Feeling unwell? Go back to last week's target until you feel fine. Drink a glass of water with every meal.



Hummus bowls with chard, cucumber, cauliflower, sugar snaps and sesame.

THIS WEEK, DO THIS

- [ ] Add a tin of beans, lentils or chickpeas to at least four meals.
- [ ] Make one white-to-wholegrain swap and keep it.
- [ ] Put a bowl of chopped veg on the table while dinner cooks.
- [ ] Make Vishen's green smoothie twice this week.

BUY PRE-COOKED

Tinned or carton beans are as good as dried for fibre. Choose ones with no added salt, rinse them, and keep three kinds in the cupboard.

Plants this week

Write each new plant in a box the first time you eat it this week.

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

Daily log

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Fibre (g)							
Water (glasses)							
New plants							
Gut feel (1-5)							

WHAT WORKED, AND WHAT I'LL KEEP

03

Grow *the forest.*

This is the variety week. You're eating enough fibre now, so make it more varied. New colours, new grains, new beans, a fuller spice rack. Every new plant feeds a different set of bacteria.

TARGET: 25-30 G A DAY **GOAL: 25 PLANTS THIS WEEK**

Feeling unwell? Go back to last week's target until you feel fine. Drink a glass of water with every meal.



Roast courgette, tomatoes, Romanesco, cauliflower and squash.

THIS WEEK, DO THIS

- [ ] Eat at least three plants you haven't had yet this month.
- [ ] Cook with herbs and spices every day. They're the easiest plants to add.
- [ ] Mix it up: three kinds of bean in one salad, two grains in one pot.
- [ ] Buy the mixed bag: mixed seeds, mixed leaves, frozen mixed berries.

THE SHOPPING TRICK

Each shop, swap one usual item for something new in the same group. Pear for apple, buckwheat for rice, borlotti for kidney beans. Same effort, one more plant.

Plants this week

Write each new plant in a box the first time you eat it this week.

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

Daily log

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Fibre (g)							
Water (glasses)							
New plants							
Gut feel (1-5)							

WHAT WORKED, AND WHAT I'LL KEEP

04

Make it *stick.*

Nine days to the finish. The goal now is to make 30-30 the way you eat by default, with no tracker, no thinking and no willpower. Batch-cook, set up your kitchen, and bring the people you live with along.

TARGET: 30 G+ A DAY

GOAL: 30 PLANTS THIS WEEK

Feeling unwell? Go back to last week's target until you feel fine. Drink a glass of water with every meal.



Black rice, avocado, edamame, tenderstem, red cabbage and beetroot.

THIS WEEK, DO THIS

- [ ] Pair a fermented food with fibre most days: kefir, live yoghurt, sauerkraut or kimchi.
- [ ] Batch-cook one big pot or tray you can eat from for three days.
- [ ] Hit 30 g on at least one day without the breakfast bowl.
- [ ] Write the ten plants you'll keep buying after the challenge.

BRING THE FAMILY

Children who help shop and cook are more likely to taste the result. Put the seed jar on the table and let everyone sprinkle their own. See page 15.

Plants this week

Write each new plant in a box the first time you eat it this week.

1	2	3	4	5	6
7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24
25	26	27	28	29	30

Daily log

	M 7	T 8	W 9	T 10	F 11	S 12	S 13	M 14	T 15
Fibre (g)									
Water (glasses)									
New plants									
Gut feel (1-5)									

WHAT WORKED, AND WHAT I'LL KEEP

Feed the whole *household.*

Alba tests the gut microbiome of children from birth, and many of its customers are parents. Children need fibre too, and the habits they learn at your table tend to last.

How much fibre children need

AGE	FIBRE A DAY (UK)
2 to 5 years	15 g
5 to 11 years	20 g
11 to 16 years	25 g
16 and over	30 g

Under-twos don't have a set target. Offer a range of fruit, vegetables and whole grains as they start solids, and speak to your health visitor about anything specific.

Ideas that work with children

- [ ] **Toppings jar.** Let them sprinkle seeds, berries and nut butter on their own yoghurt or porridge.
- [ ] **Half and half.** Swap half the white flour in pancakes or baking for wholemeal, buckwheat or chickpea flour.
- [ ] **Hide and show.** Blend veg into sauces and soups, and serve some whole on the plate too, so they learn what it looks like.
- [ ] **Veg before dinner.** Put out chopped cucumber, pepper and carrot with hummus while you cook. Hungry children graze.
- [ ] **Dips help.** Hummus, guacamole and yoghurt dips make raw veg more appealing.

For picky eaters

Advice Alba shares from child-feeding expert Dr Colette Reynolds:

- It can take **12 to 20 tries** before a child accepts a new food. Keep offering, without pressure.
- Always include one food they usually eat, so the table feels safe.
- Count touching, smelling or licking a new food as progress.
- Move in small steps. Green apple before peas. Thick chips, then wedges, then mash.
- Keep mealtimes calm. Connection first, food second.



A fruit platter is an easy family win: nine plants nobody has to be talked into.

Thirty days later. *What changed?*

Measure the same way you did on day one, at the same time of day. Then score yourself again and compare.

	DAY 1	DAY 31
Waist or hips (cm)		
Fibre on a typical day (g)		
Plants in my last 7 days		
Energy (1-10)		
Digestion (1-10)		
Bloating (1-10)		
Sleep (1-10)		
Mood (1-10)		
Skin (1-10)		
Cravings (1-10)		

THE CHANGE I NOTICED MOST

MY TEN GO-TO PLANTS FROM NOW ON

THE MEAL I'LL KEEP MAKING

WHAT I'D TELL A FRIEND STARTING THIS

Share your result

Post your before and after numbers, your favourite recipe and one thing you learned in the challenge community. Vishen and Nora want to hear what changed for you.

After day 30

Keep the breakfast bowl, the seed jar and the tins of beans. Count your plants on Sundays for a few more weeks. Everyone's gut is different, so if you want to see what yours actually needs, page 18 explains how a gut test works.

What we know, *and what we don't.*

Vishen walked through several of these studies on the podcast and was careful to say which ones are early. Here they are, with the same honesty.

STRONG

Fibre and long-term health

A review for the World Health Organization pooled about 185 observational studies and 58 trials. People eating 25 to 29 g of fibre a day had 15 to 30% lower death rates from all causes and from heart disease than those eating the least, with less stroke, type 2 diabetes and bowel cancer. Benefits continued above 30 g. Reynolds et al., The Lancet, 2019.

STRONG

How little we eat

Only 4% of UK adults reach 30 g a day, and 7% know the recommendation exists. British Nutrition Foundation, 2026, using national diet survey data.

PROMISING

30 plants a week

In over 11,000 citizen-science volunteers, those eating more than 30 plant types a week had more fibre-fermenting gut bacteria than those eating fewer than 10. An association from a survey question, not a tested threshold. McDonald et al., mSystems, 2018.

STRONG

One rule against thirteen

240 adults with metabolic syndrome, followed for a year. One group got the full American Heart Association diet. The other got one rule: eat at least 30 g of fibre a day. They lost 2.7 kg and 2.1 kg, a difference too small to be sure of. Ma et al., Annals of Internal Medicine, 2015.

PROMISING

Fibre and weight loss

In a six-month trial of four different diets with 345 people, fibre intake predicted weight loss better than the diet people were on. A secondary analysis, so it shows a link, not a cause. Miketinas et al., Journal of Nutrition, 2019.

PROMISING

Fibre and grip strength

60 frail adults over 65 in Spanish care homes took a prebiotic fibre powder (inulin and FOS) or a placebo for 13 weeks. The fibre group had stronger grip and reported less exhaustion. Small, and needs repeating. Buigues et al., International Journal of Molecular Sciences, 2016.

PROMISING

Fibre and mood

A review of 18 studies linked higher fibre intake with about 10% lower odds of depression in adults, and much lower odds in teenagers. Most were snapshots, so the arrow could point either way, and trials are mixed. Saghafian et al., British Journal of Nutrition, 2023.

STRONG
Large reviews or randomised trials with consistent results.

PROMISING
Smaller trials or studies that show a link but can't prove cause.

No study has tested a 30-day fibre challenge. Thirty days is long enough to build the habit and notice how you feel. Changes to the gut microbiome itself can take longer, and vary from person to person.

Everything you need *for the 30 days.*

Live

Three live calls with Nora

Nora goes live roughly every ten days during the challenge to teach, answer questions and share what she sees in thousands of gut tests. You don't have to attend, but people who do tend to get more out of the month. Dates and links arrive by email.

App

Track it with Vibrantly

Vishen built Vibrantly after AI spotted his fibre gap. Photograph what you eat and it tracks your fibre, protein and macros, then suggests what to add to the meal in front of you to raise the fibre. Free for 14 days on the App Store and Google Play.

Join

The challenge community

A free community with a daily prompt from 16 November to 16 December. Share your bowls, swap recipes, ask questions and see what everyone else is eating. Your link is in your welcome email.

Test

See what your gut needs, with Alba Health

Alba's home test analyses the bacteria in your gut, or your child's, and turns the results into a personal plan: which foods to add, and which probiotics, if any, suit you. Co-founded with microbiome scientist Prof. Willem de Vos and trusted by more than 5,000 families. Start with the free two-minute gut health assessment at **albahealth.com**.

Please read. This guide is general wellness education, not medical advice, and doesn't replace your doctor. If you have a digestive condition such as IBS or IBD, are pregnant or breastfeeding, take regular medication, or want to change a child's diet a lot, speak to a health professional first. Increase fibre gradually and drink plenty of water. Take psyllium with a full glass of water and at least two hours apart from medicines, as it can slow how they're absorbed. Results described here are personal experiences and will vary.